The US Midterms 2026

The Key Facts:

- federal elections held exactly two years into a US president's four-year term (midpoint)
- all 435 seats in the House of Representatives
- roughly ⅓ of the Senate members
- Election Day is Tuesday, 3 November 2026
- the president is not on the ballot, so this is about Congress, not the White House

The Basics:

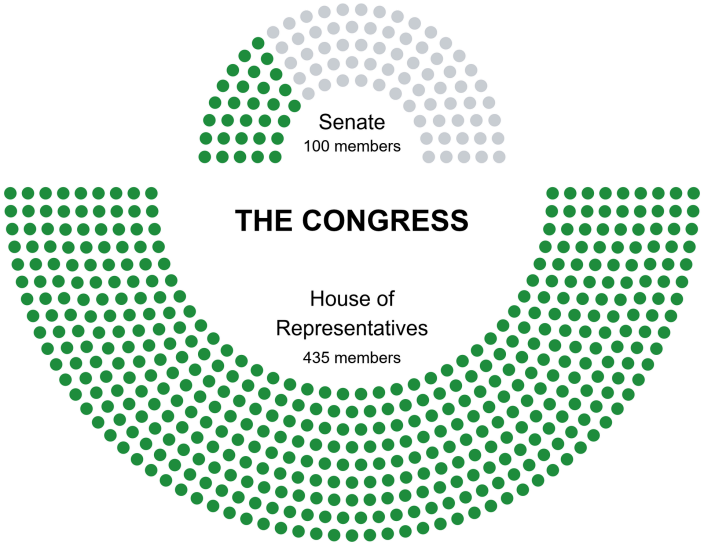
- Congress is the part of government that makes federal laws, and it has two chambers: the House and the Senate
- the US has two main parties, the Republicans and the Democrats, and nearly every seat is won by one of them
- the current president is Donald Trump, in his second term, so these results will say a lot about how voters feel halfway through his term
- voters elect people for their own district (House) and their own state (Senate), not for the country as a whole
- in many states you have to register to vote ahead of time
- Election Day is a normal working day in the US, not a public holiday

The Senate	The House of Representatives
35/100 (35% contested)	435/435 (100% contested)
The Upper Chamber (6-Year Terms)	The People's Chamber (2-Year Terms)
The Senate has exclusive power to confirm U.S. presidential appointments, to approve or reject treaties, and to convict or exonerate impeachment cases brought by the House	The House's exclusive powers include initiating all revenue bills, impeaching federal officers, and electing the president if no candidate receives a majority of votes in the Electoral College.

How do the Midterms work?

- every state runs its own voting, so details like early and mail voting differ by state
- House seats are won district by district, Senate seats state by state
- the winners take their seats in the new Congress in January
- if the president's party loses control of a chamber, passing their agenda gets much harder
- results for close races can take days to confirm, especially where lots of ballots arrive by mail, so the winner isn't always clear on election night

Who actually gets voted for?



- all 435 seats in the House of Representatives are contested
- roughly ⅓ of the Senate members will face voters (35 seats this time)

- House members serve two-year terms, so the whole chamber is up every election
- senators serve six-year terms, staggered so only a third is up at a time

Why are they important?

- the results decide who controls the House and Senate for the next two years
- they work as a halfway report card on the sitting president, Donald Trump
- they show the political mood of the country at the midpoint of a presidency
- whoever controls Congress shapes which laws can pass and what issues get looked at
- The result of the elections can have international consequences, it can for example influence the oil prices which we have seen happening before